CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

MOBILE MECHANIC (OWNER) IN THE AI ERA

The shop comes to the customer — and no robot is fixing a starter motor in a driveway any time soon.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K a year running your own one-van repair business, set up in 1–6 months if you already know the work. The catch: you are the mechanic, the dispatcher and the warranty department. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

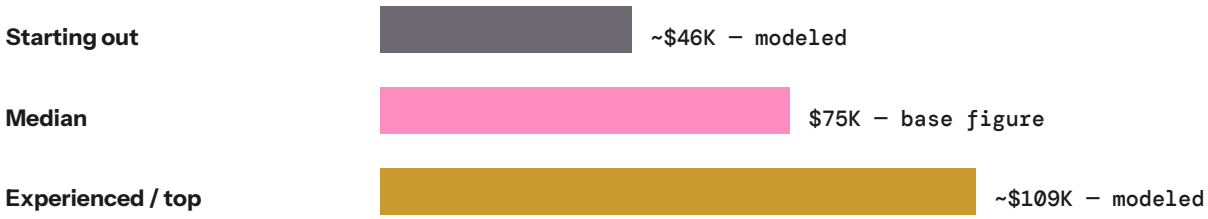
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Customers pay for convenience — repairs at their home or office, no tow truck, no waiting room.
- No shop lease means the overhead that kills most garages never shows up.
- Your ceiling is your calendar: one pair of hands bills only so many hours a day.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Mobile Mechanic (owner) is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A MOBILE MECHANIC (OWNER) ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Drive to customers and diagnose and repair cars on driveways, lots and roadsides

✓ Quote jobs, order parts and manage the day's route
✓ Do brakes, batteries, starters, alternators and diagnostics on site
✓ Handle invoices, reviews and repeat-customer reminders yourself

Think: a food truck, except the kitchen is a toolbox and the customers are broken-down cars.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI is taking the desk work: booking, quotes, diagnostic suggestions from error codes, parts lookups and review requests can all be automated or AI-assisted.	The wrench work stays human. Crawling under a car, feeling a worn bearing, improvising around a rusted bolt in someone's driveway — that is hands, judgment and trust, sold face to face.

⚠ **Weather, darkness and jobs that turn out to need a lift will test you. And with no employer, slow weeks pay exactly zero — the phone has to keep ringing.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ No boss, no shop rent, your own schedule ✓ Every day is a different place and a different car ✓ Customers treat you like a rescuer, not a vendor	✗ You work outdoors in whatever weather shows up ✗ Income stops the day you stop turning wrenches ✗ Evenings go to quotes, parts orders and paperwork

Good fit? An experienced mechanic who likes people, hates shop politics and wants the margin that used to go to the shop owner.
Bad fit? You want predictable hours, a heated bay and someone else finding your customers.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — LEAVE THE SHOP WITH SKILLS	DOOR B — NICHE DOWN FROM DAY ONE
The standard route: work as a mechanic first, build real diagnostic skill, then go mobile with your own tools, a van or truck, business registration and insurance. Start part-time on weekends if you need the paycheck while you build a client list.	Skip general repair and own one thing: fleet maintenance for small businesses, pre-purchase inspections, or battery and brake service for a few dense neighborhoods. A niche is easier to market and easier to route.

Smart move: Sell subscriptions, not just repairs: a local business with ten vans will pay a monthly retainer for priority service — that is rent money that arrives even in slow weeks.
Where you land after: A booked-out solo route, then a second van and a hired mechanic — or a small fleet-service company.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
BE HONEST	SET UP	BUILD THE	PRICE AND	GET FOUND	RUN IT

STEP 1 — Be honest about your skill level

FREE · TODAY

- Mobile work means no senior tech looking over your shoulder — list what you can diagnose and fix solo, without a lift.
- If the list is short, this roadmap starts after shop experience, not before.

STEP 2 — Set up the business shell

$100-500 · 1-2 WEEKS

- Register the business, get liability insurance and a business bank account.
- No mechanic license is required in most places to run the business — but check your local rules before the first job.

STEP 3 — Build the mobile rig

$2,000-10,000 · 2-4 WEEKS

- Reliable vehicle, jack and stands, diagnostic scanner, battery tools, lighting and the common-parts kit.
- Buy for the jobs you will actually take — brakes, batteries, starters, diagnostics — not for everything.

STEP 4 — Price and package the work

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Set a call-out fee plus hourly or flat job pricing; publish the menu for common jobs.
- Write your warranty and your limits down — what you will not do without a lift goes in writing.

STEP 5 — Get found locally

$0-300 · ONGOING

- Google Business Profile, reviews from day one, and a simple booking page.
- Partner with offices, fleets and property managers who see broken cars every day.

STEP 6 — Run it like a route, not a hobby

PAID · FROM WEEK 4

- Cluster jobs by area, confirm the night before, and text customers your arrival window.
- Track which jobs make money per hour — and quietly drop the ones that never do.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: write your honest solo-repair list and the menu of jobs you will offer.

□ Days 1–30: register the business, get insurance, set up the vehicle and tools, open the Google profile.

□ Days 31–60: take your first paying jobs — friends-of-friends count — and collect a review after every single one.

□ Days 61–90: tighten the route, add one fleet or office partner, and set prices that reflect real demand.

□ Day 90: you have a working route business — the question now is hours: raise prices or plan the second van.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **THE SHOP IS WHEREVER YOU PARK.** ★